

EXT. SIDEWALK - NIGHT

A sidewalk in downtown LA after a rainy night. There are puddles on the street, mist, and a couple shadowy people in the distance.

TEXT: 1992

We hear hurried footsteps and a young boy talking to someone.

BOY (O.S.)
Come on, we're late!

Two kids run into frame. These kids are VINCENT DEVEREAUX (11, white) and EMI-CLAIRE MORITA (11, Japanese mixed with white).

VINCENT
Em, take my hand.

Vincent extends his hand to Emi-Claire who takes it as the unaccompanied kids run forward into the misty downtown Los Angeles.

INT. MOVIE THEATER - LOBBY - NIGHT

Vincent and Emi-Claire hurry into a movie theater. It's decked out in 90s wallpaper and lighting. They're wet from the rain.

EMI-CLAIRE
I'll get popcorn and soda. I know you don't wanna miss any of the movie.

VINCENT
Thanks. Here's your ticket.

Vincent hands Emi-Claire her ticket.

VINCENT (CONT'D)
Wait.

Vincent digs in his pocket and pulls out a crumpled \$10 bill, handing it to Emi-Claire.

EMI-CLAIRE
Thanks!

Vincent smiles.

VINCENT
See you inside.

INT. MOVIE THEATER - THEATER ROOM - NIGHT

Vincent makes his way into the theater room. It's mostly empty, save for 3 or so people scattered around the rows. The movie's opening credits have already started.

Vincent sits in an empty row and shifts his focus to the movie. He's clearly more interested in movies than most kids his age, and likely more interested than people in general.

It's a classic 90s comedy. Vincent watches with focus for a little bit until Emi-Claire comes into the theater carrying popcorn and soda. She makes her way to Vincent and smiles before sitting next to him.

EMI-CLAIRE

Best seats in the house.

VINCENT

Mm-hm.

Vincent nods and they look at each other. Emi-Claire blushes and smiles causing Vincent to do the same.

The kids shift their attention back to the movie when the main character says something funny. There are a couple chuckles from around the theater while Vincent and Emi-Claire look at each other and laugh.

Emi-Claire has her hand on her armrest. Vincent looks at it and nervously slides his hand on top of hers.

Emi-Claire blushes heavily and looks at Vincent. A nervous slowly goes in for a kiss.

They kiss, very shortly and pull back sharply after. They both smile as-

MATCH CUT TO:

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT - 12 YEARS LATER

A TV showing VINCENT (now 22) smiling at the camera while sitting in a chair. He's wearing a suit and smiling more nonchalantly, at an award show. There's a person narrating the broadcast.

TEXT: 2003

ANNOUNCER

Vincent Devereaux in attendance tonight, of course he's nominated for best actor for BACK HOME.

We pan out to see two Asian kids (KAI,9, and DANIEL,8,) watching the TV in awe of Vincent. Kai turns around and looks up to someone.

KAI

Emi, do you still talk to him?

22 YEAR OLD EMI-CLAIRE steps towards the TV as the camera pans away from Vincent.

EMI-CLAIRE

Well-

She looks at the TV then back at her little cousins.

EMI-CLAIRE (CONT'D)

No, actually. It's been a while.

Kai turns back to Daniel.

KAI

He's definitely winning tonight.
He'll probably win an Oscar too.

DANIEL

Nah, the Oscars won't let him win
until he's way older. He should
though.

EMI-CLAIRE

Did you guys even watch BACK HOME?

DANIEL

No, but he should've won for
REVENGERS.

KAI

Everyone says BACK HOME's boring.
He should've made another action
movie.

DANIEL

But people say he's really good in
BACK HOME. He can do action and
serious stuff.

Emi-Claire slightly smiles at the kids then walks into the kitchen.

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - KITCHEN - NIGHT

Emi-Claire heads into the kitchen where her MOTHER (61, Japanese), SISTER (LILY-MAE, 26, Japanese-White), and COUSIN (HANA, 17, Japanese) are making dinner.

They are making Okonomiyaki. Emi-Claire's mom is doing most of the work with the others helping. Emi-Claire's mom has broken English.

EMI-CLAIRE'S MOM
Hey Emi! How you feel?

EMI-CLAIRE
I'm okay. Need help?

EMI-CLAIRE'S MOM
Yeah. Can you make sauce?

Emi-Claire nods and finds a spot in the kitchen.

LILY-MAE
Should we be letting the boys watch that? They look up to Vincent a lot.

EMI-CLAIRE
It's alright. Let them have their idols, we had ours.

LILY-MAE
Yeah okay, but Vincent sucks. We don't want them turning out like him.

EMI-CLAIRE
He doesn't suck.

HANA
He sucks!

LILY-MAE
Seriously.

EMI-CLAIRE
You're just saying that because we know him. Our idols have their problems too, we just don't know about them.

Emi-Claire's mom shakes her head.

EMI-CLAIRE'S MOM
No good.

LILY-MAE

What do the kids think is so cool about smoking cigarettes and breaking girls hearts? And if I'm being honest, he's not THAT good of an actor.

EMI-CLAIRE

Okay guys, come on! I don't want to talk about this right now.

EMI-CLAIRE'S MOM

He hurt you, Emi-Claire. He doesn't deserve special night.

EMI-CLAIRE

Let's move on. Please?

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - DINING ROOM - NIGHT

The Okonomiyaki is served at the table. Everyone we've been introduced to so far is at the table in addition to TERUKO (Emi-Claire's aunt, 50s, Japanese) and EMI-CLAIRE'S DAD (early 60s, white). It's a loud but warm environment.

EMI-CLAIRE'S MOM

(Japanese)

Emi-Claire, can you get your grandpa?

Emi-Claire nods and heads upstairs.

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - GRANDPA'S ROOM - NIGHT

Emi-Claire enters her GRANDPA'S (late 80s, Japanese) room. He's very old with an oxygen tank and a TV running quietly.

ENTIRE conversation in JAPANESE, Emi-Claire's grandpa doesn't speak English.

EMI-CLAIRE

Hi grandpa.

EMI-CLAIRE'S GRANDPA

Hello, Emi-Claire.

EMI-CLAIRE

Dinner's ready. Let's go.

Emi-Claire walks to her grandpa and helps him stand up.

EMI-CLAIRE'S GRANDPA
Is school going well?

EMI-CLAIRE
Yeah, very well.

Emi-Claire smiles at him.

EMI-CLAIRE'S GRANDPA
I'm very proud of you. You're going
to do great things.

EMI-CLAIRE
Thank you.

They walk out of the room together.

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - DINING ROOM - NIGHT

Emi-Claire walks her grandpa downstairs, back into the
frantic dining room. She sits him down and takes her seat.

Teruko gets up and yells at the table-

TERUKO
(Japanese)
Everyone, quiet please!

The table quiets down and everyone puts their hands together.

EVERYONE
Itadakimasu.

People start taking pieces of the Okonomiyaki and talking
with each other. The food looks amazing and everyone is
digging in.

A little bit into dinner Daniel slips away from the table and
runs to the TV.

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Daniel makes it to the TV just in time for the best
supporting actor to be announced. The winner begins walking
up for his speech.

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - DINING ROOM - NIGHT

Daniel runs back to the table.

DANIEL

Guys, guys! They're announcing best actor!

All conversations at the table stop. Multiple people look at Emi-Claire. Her dad tries to shrug it off.

EMI-CLAIRE'S DAD

It's the middle of dinner, guys. We can find out who won later.

Kai jumps up and follows Daniel into the living room. Emi-Claire stands up and starts walking over too, causing everyone except Emi-Claire's dad and her grandpa to follow.

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

The family gathers around the TV and watches in anticipation. The camera shows Vincent again, sitting with his MOM (41, white).

ANNOUNCER

And now, the nominees for best actor...

The broadcast shows four nominees as they get announced by the announcer and cuts to Vincent as the last nominee.

The camera pans into the TV, transitioning to-

INT. AWARDS CEREMONY - NIGHT

Vincent seated in the ceremony. We're following him now as the announcer (who we can now see) reads off his name-

ANNOUNCER

Vincent Devereaux in BACK HOME.

Vincent gets the most applause out of any of the nominees. He smiles at a camera very slightly and turns back to the announcer.

ANNOUNCER (CONT'D)

And the winner is...

The announcer opens her card and looks out towards the audience. She smiles-

ANNOUNCER (CONT'D)

Vincent Devereaux!

By the time she says Vincent people are already cheering. Vincent, seemingly not surprised, hugs his mom and stands up, walking towards the stage. We get to see his full outfit, a sleek, stylish suit, designer shoes, and a diamond bedazzled Rolex.

He nods to someone on his way up, getting on stage and side-hugging the announcer, then taking the award. He walks up to the mic and looks into the crowd and flashing lights. He gives another one of his nonchalant smiles.

VINCENT

Thank you everyone. Um-

He pauses for a second.

VINCENT (CONT'D)

Thank you to everyone that worked on the movie, thank you to my team. I had faith that everything would work out and it did. I love my fans, I love my momma.

Vincent nods and walks off. There's a roar of applause.

EXT. CEREMONY VENUE - NIGHT

A Rolls-Royce pulls up to a walkway on the side of the building. There are security guards and the walkway is roped off.

Vincent exits the building with his mom, opening the Rolls Royce door for her and following her in.

INT. ROLLS ROYCE - NIGHT

Vincent sighs and slouches back with his award. He looks up at the stars on the roof. The car starts driving as Vincent's mom smiles at him.

VINCENT'S MOM

Look at my award winning son, in his nice fancy car, with his shiny watch, taking care of his mom.

Vincent smiles and slightly chuckles.

VINCENT'S MOM (CONT'D)

You really turned into a fine young man.

VINCENT

I mean, I'm doing pretty good.

Vincent makes his signature smile again.

VINCENT (CONT'D)

We came a long way from that Camry,
didn't we?

Vincent's mom laughs and Vincent smiles harder.

VINCENT'S MOM

Yeah, we did!

VINCENT

It was a good car though, you know?
Good memories.

VINCENT'S MOM

Yeah, too bad we had to trade it
for this little Rolls-Royce.

Vincent smirks.

EXT. VINCENT'S HOUSE - NIGHT

The Rolls Royce drives up to Vincent's house. It's a medium sized house in the hills.

Vincent gets out of the car and goes to the side to open the car door for his mom. She gets out with his award and hugs him tight.

VINCENT'S MOM

I really want you to know how proud
I am of you. I love you so much.

VINCENT

I love you too, mom.

VINCENT'S MOM

See you tonight. Don't party too
much, young man.

VINCENT

Okay.

They break the hug and Vincent gets in the passenger seat of the Rolls-Royce while his mom walks to the house.

INT. ROLLS ROYCE - NIGHT

Vincent gets comfortable in his seat. The DRIVER (early 20s, male, luxury goth style) looks at Vincent.

DIVER
Front seat?

VINCENT
I like talking to people face to face.

The driver nods. He starts the car and turns on the radio.

MUSIC CUE: HEY MA BY CAM'RON - subject to change based on rights but I really really want to use this song.

FADE TO:

INT. MANSION - NIGHT

The song continues as we're put in a high class Hollywood mansion party. The house is packed with people doing cocaine, drinking, dancing, and talking all around the two story house.

Vincent walks in alone and is instantly cheered on and greeted by several people. Vincent doesn't pay too much mind to anyone, just nodding and waving as he walks by and getting a few photos.

While walking he sees a BEAUTIFUL GIRL (22, LATINA) who eyes him and waves. He flips a peace sign to her and keeps walking.

Vincent goes to a table with a bunch of champagne and pours himself a glass. He takes a big sip then pours again. The Latina girl walks up to him.

LATINA GIRL
What's good?

VINCENT
Hey.

The girl pours herself a glass of champagne.

LATINA GIRL
Congratulations on the award. Your movie was real good.

VINCENT
Thanks.

LATINA GIRL

I'm Carmen.

VINCENT

Nice to meet you. I'm Vincent.

Carmen laughs.

CARMEN

I know!

VINCENT

So, what do you do?

CARMEN

I'm a model.

Vincent smirks.

VINCENT

Yeah?

Carmen pours more champagne into Vincent's glass.

VINCENT (CONT'D)

Who you modeled for?

CARMEN

Ed Hardy, Louis V...

Carmen looks at Vincent intensely and whispers seductively.

CARMEN (CONT'D)

Playboy.

Vincent looks at her sly with his drink in his hand and smiles.

VINCENT

Is that so?

CARMEN

Mm-hm.

Vincent nods.

VINCENT

Okay.

CARMEN

You think I got a model body?

Carmen turns around to show Vincent her ass. She's wearing a tight dress and presses her ass against Vincent. He grabs her hips and she smiles.

VINCENT

I can see it.

They sway to the music for a second and Carmen pulls a bag out of her purse that has tabs of ecstasy. Vincent talks gently to her.

VINCENT (CONT'D)

Nah, girl.

CARMEN

It won't kill you!

VINCENT

I'm having dinner with my parents after this. I'm sticking with the chill shit tonight.

CARMEN

Fair enough. Another time, hit me up.

Vincent nods and Carmen takes a tab, then hands Vincent her flip-phone. Vincent puts his number in and gives her the phone back. He lets go of her and turns so he can face her.

VINCENT

Well I gotta talk to some other people, but I'll catch you.

They both go in for a kiss and while they kiss Vincent rubs his hand down her ass. He pulls away and she smiles at him.

CARMEN

Enjoy your night. Call me if you get too lonely.

Vincent smiles and walks off.

INT. MANSION - KITCHEN - NIGHT

Vincent walks in the kitchen with more champagne. He's starting to get a little drunk as he runs into ROBERTO (40s, the producer of BACK HOME and also the person who threw the party).

VINCENT

Hey, Roberto!

They hug and cheers.

ROBERTO
Vinny, my boy, congratulations! You
deserve that damn award.

VINCENT
You as well. Best picture, that's
major.

ROBERTO
Yeah, well it was an easy win.
Everyone knew we'd sweep because
you're so young and cool. But we
won't win any Oscars because you're
so young and cool.

VINCENT
It'll come, it'll come.

ROBERTO
Have you been drinking, Vinny?

VINCENT
Yeah, you just cheers'd me.

ROBERTO
Oh, fuck.

Vincent laughs.

VINCENT
We did good. I love you, thanks for
everything.

ROBERTO
We'll go far together, Vinny. I'm
glad I got YOU on my side. And hey,
we sent you the script for
REVENGERS 2. It's fucking
spectacular.

VINCENT
We got this.

They hug again briefly.

ROBERTO
Am I a good host? Is the party
good?

VINCENT
It's great, Roberto. It is.

ROBERTO
Great! See you soon, Vinny.

VINCENT
For sure.

EXT. MANSION - NIGHT

Vincent goes outside to the big backyard, where there's a pool and a group of people passing a blunt around. Vincent has two glasses of champagne now and sets them down, joining the circle.

A GUY IN THE CIRCLE (24, black) smiles and walks over to Vincent. He's very 2000s hip hop, with baggy clothes, a low hanging chain, and grillz.

GUY
Aw, wassup Vincent? It's good to meet you, I'm Ace Wess.

VINCENT
It's good to meet you too. I've been bumping *On Blast* for a while now.

ACE
Damn g, for real?

VINCENT
Yeah, in the Rolls Royce.

Ace jumps back and laughs.

ACE
Shi, in the Rolls? That's hard! Come hit the blunt, g.

VINCENT
Alright, alright.

Vincent follows Ace back to the circle and he gets passed the blunt.

ACE
Y'all, this is Vincent, but y'all probably know him. The Revenger himself.

People say hi to him and give him some congratulations. He hits the blunt for about two seconds and passes it to Ace.

ACE (CONT'D)

Ay, that n**** fresh, that suit
hella clean.

VINCENT

Thanks.

ACE

You got a stylist?

VINCENT

No.

Ace hits the blunt and passes it out.

ACE

Shit, a motherfucker just know how
to dress.

The blunt gets finished before it can get back to Vincent.
Ace lights a new one and passes it to Vincent. He hits it
twice this time and passes it the other way.

VINCENT

Alright, I'm probably gonna head
out. I've got dinner with my mom
and dad.

ACE

Aight, it was good to meet you.
Slide me your number so we can kick
it sometime.

Vincent gives Ace his phone and says bye to the people in the
circle. A WHITE GIRL (20) in the circle asks him-

WHITE GIRL

Can I get your number too?

While she asks this the weed kicks in and he starts losing
his focus.

VINCENT

Sure.

She smiles and Vincent motions to Ace to pass the phone to
the girl. He does and she puts her number in. He makes eye
contact with her, as he gets lost in her face.

WHITE GIRL

I'm Hailey.

VINCENT

Nice to meet you.

WHITE GIRL

Yeah! You too.

Vincent starts to walk away without his phone.

ACE

Ay Vince! Your phone!

Vincent turns around and gets his phone back. He daps up Ace and walks away calling his ride.

INT. MANSION - NIGHT

Vincent walks back through the main hall faded and having trouble with directions. He finds Carmen by chance talking to a guy and grabs her hand. She turns and follows him. The guy looks at them in disappointment.

EXT. MANSION - NIGHT

Carmen and Vincent head out of the mansion past a guy throwing up and to the Rolls Royce. Vincent pushes her to the side of the car and starts making out with her against the car.

He grabs and caresses her ass and starts reaching up her skirt. Carmen pulls his hand down and lets up.

CARMEN

Wait till we get in the car.

VINCENT

I like my driver, I don't want to force him to hear us.

CARMEN

Then take me home with you and wait till-

VINCENT

I have to have this dinner with my family.

CARMEN

Dinner? It's already midnight.

VINCENT

My parents hate each other and they're in the same room for the first time in 20 years, just for me.

CARMEN

Well let's go back in the house
real quick.. upstairs. There's
people all around us!

Vincent laughs.

VINCENT

Who, the guy throwing up on the
grass? He won't remember.

Carmen groans and grabs Vincent's hand, pulling him back.
Vincent smiles.

VINCENT (CONT'D)

Wait, wait!

Vincent pulls away and knocks on the window of the Rolls
Royce. The driver rolls the window down.

VINCENT (CONT'D)

Tim, give me five minutes, I'm
sorry!

Carmen laughs and tries to pull him back jokingly.

DRIVER/TIM

You're good, Vince.

VINCENT

Tim, here-

Carmen tickles Vincent and he laughs. He goes back to the
window and hands Vincent a couple hundreds.

VINCENT (CONT'D)

Here, five minutes.

TIM

Alright.

Carmen pulls Vincent back who grabs her hand and they go back
into the house.

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Emi-Claire is sitting on the couch with Lily-Mae and Hana.
They're watching a late night game show.

LILY-MAE

I don't mean to upset you Emi, but
how are you feeling?

EMI-CLAIRE
I'm happy for him, you know..

LILY-MAE
Yeah.

They sit in silence for a bit watching the show.

EMI-CLAIRE
Do you think he still thinks of me?
More silence. Then-

HANA
I think so. You guys went to prom together. He's known you since you were kids.

LILY-MAE
Who cares? And can we talk about his shitty speech?

EMI-CLAIRE
I'm gonna call him.

LILY-MAE
Emi-Claire! Are you crazy?

Emi-Claire stands up and walks to the landline.

EMI-CLAIRE
Just to check up, that's it!

HANA
Em.. I don't know.

EMI-CLAIRE
We were close, it'd be wrong to not congratulate him.

Emi-Claire dials a number on the landline.

INT. VINCENT'S MOM'S HOUSE - NIGHT

The house phone rings in Vincent's mom's house but she's not home. It goes to voicemail and Emi-Claire leaves a message.

EMI-CLAIRE (V.O.)
Hey Vincent, I know it's been a while since we talked but I just wanted to congratulate you on the award.

INT. MANSION - BEDROOM - NIGHT

Carmen is sitting on top of Vincent, kissing him while he lays on the bed. Vincent pulls her shirt and bra down as the voice-over continues.

EMI-CLAIRE (V.O.)
I know you're pretty busy with your
career and I don't know if you'll
even get this because I don't have
your real phone number-

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Back to Emi-Claire talking on the phone.

EMI-CLAIRE
But I just wanted to let you know
I'm doing good, same with my
family. I'm in college now.
Straight A's!

Emi-Claire smiles to herself then looks back to her family.
They give her sarcastic looks.

INT. MANSION - BEDROOM - NIGHT

Shots of Vincent fondling Carmen's waist, her clenching his forearm and putting ecstasy on his tongue.

EMI-CLAIRE (V.O.)
I'm glad you're doing good too, and
I still think about the good times
we had.

INT. FAMILY HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Back to Emi-Claire.

EMI-CLAIRE
If you ever wanted to meet up you
could give me a call.
(chuckle)
I'm still in the same place. And I
still-

The voicemail reaches its time limit and beeps.

EMI-CLAIRE (CONT'D)
Oh.

Emi-Claire turns to her family and gives a slight, sad, smile.

LILY-MAE

Em, I don't really get it. It's not the fame is it?

EMI-CLAIRE

No it's not the fame, Lily! God, why do you care so much?

LILY-MAE

Relax, I'm just trying to talk to you.

Emi-Claire groans in frustration and walks off.

EXT. VINCENT'S HOUSE - NIGHT

It's much later at night now, and Vincent stumbles out of his car, falling onto the driveway. Tim gets out to help him.

Vincent lies down on the driveway, cross-faded on a jumble of drugs, staring into the stars.

VINCENT

You think my parents killed each other yet?

TIM

Who knows? Maybe they made up.

Vincent lets out a loud laugh as Tim lifts him up and helps him walk inside.

VINCENT

Hollywood..

TIM

Yeah.

Tim carries Vincent into the house.

INT. VINCENT'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Inside Vincent's house is VINCENT'S DAD (mid 40s, white, bald), VINCENT'S DAD'S GIRLFRIEND (mid 40s, Latin), and Vincent's mom.

There's a REVENGERS poster featuring Vincent on the front cover. It's an action crime movie.

Vincent's dad and his girlfriend are on the couch together while Vincent's mom is on a nearby chair reading a book. There's a couple wine glasses and it's civil, but Vincent's parents aren't very warm to each other.

Tim walks Vincent in and everyone stands up, waiting their turn to hug and talk to him. Tim walks back to the car.

VINCENT'S MOM
Vincent, what'd you take?

VINCENT
Sorry, mom. I'm fine though,
really!

Vincent moves on to hugging his dad.

VINCENT'S DAD
About time you showed up, Jesus.

Vincent's dad laughs and Vincent cracks a smile.

VINCENT'S DAD (CONT'D)
Proud of you, kid.

Vincent's dad's girlfriend gives Vincent a hug and congratulations. Tim comes back with bags of food and sets the boxes of food on the table.

INT. VINCENT'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Vincent leads everyone to the table as Tim opens a bottle of champagne and starts pouring glasses. The food consists of fancy entrees from an upscale restaurant.

VINCENT
This place is amazing. You're gonna
love it.

Vincent raises his glass, with everyone following.

VINCENT (CONT'D)
To my accomplishment, unity, and
all that other jolly bullshit.

The people at the table react questionably to the speech but shrug it off.

VINCENT (CONT'D)
Tim, pour yourself a fucking glass.
You earned it.

TIM
I gotta drive home, Vince.

VINCENT
You can stay here tonight if you want, I don't care. Or just drive back, it's one glass of champagne. Have some fun, shit.

Tim does.

VINCENT (CONT'D)
Alright everyone, cheers!

They cheer, sip, and eat. Everyone loves it.

VINCENT'S DAD
Wow, this is really good. You weren't lying.

VINCENT
Who would've thought any of us'd be eating this one day?

Vincent, with the munchies, shoves steak into his mouth and chews, absorbing every bite.

EXT. VINCENT'S HOUSE - PATIO - NIGHT

Vincent's dad is smoking on the patio overlooking the LA skyline. Vincent comes out to join him, lighting up his own cigarette.

VINCENT'S DAD
Now what kind of dad am I smoking with my son after I got cancer from these things?

VINCENT
Fuck off, they help me sober up.

Vincent's dad scoffs as he looks out.

VINCENT'S DAD
That's a myth. They don't actually do that.

VINCENT
Well maybe these ones do.

He holds the pack up to his dad.

VINCENT (CONT'D)

The expensive shit. \$25 a pack.

His dad chuckles at the absurdity.

VINCENT'S DAD

Fucking hell.

Vincent smiles.

VINCENT'S DAD (CONT'D)

So, how was your night?

VINCENT

You know, it was really good but I don't know..

VINCENT'S DAD

Hm?

VINCENT

It's a lot. All the cameras, the drugs, the sex. It's a little too much for me, especially because it's all so fake. Just a bunch of people who can't be normal anymore still trying to be.

VINCENT'S DAD

Damn.. sounds complex.

VINCENT

Well, just the ups and downs of fame I guess. I don't really understand it yet, but I just feel the.. nothing.

Vincent shrugs.

VINCENT'S DAD

Either way, what you're doing is incredible, and I mean it. You know it too, it's more than your acting. You got me and your mom in the same room as each other!

VINCENT

How was that anyways?

VINCENT'S DAD

Fine, fine. Just a "hey, how have you been" and some other chatter.

VINCENT

Thanks for doing that for me.

VINCENT'S DAD

Anything for you, kid. You turned out more amazing than anyone could've imagined.

Vincent's dad puts his hand on Vincent's shoulder and they look out towards the skyline. Vincent's eyes strain and the stars twinkle a little brighter as he looks out.

VINCENT'S DAD (CONT'D)

I don't think I got much more time on this Earth, kiddo.

VINCENT

Have some faith. We-

VINCENT'S DAD

It's hard to have faith about those things nowadays. The late diagnosis fucked everything up, and so far chemo hasn't helped much.

(beat)

You're gonna do a lot of great things without me, and I wish I'd get to see them..

Vincent's dad holds back tears.

VINCENT'S DAD (CONT'D)

But shit, you really made my life worth something.

Vincent embraces his dad.

VINCENT'S DAD (CONT'D)

You're gonna be great, son, you already are.

They pull out of the hug and Vincent yawns.

VINCENT'S DAD (CONT'D)

You need some sleep. I'll see you soon.

VINCENT

Alright, love you.

VINCENT'S DAD

Love you too. And you know I really don't like you smoking cigarettes.

VINCENT

Right.

Vincent's dad pats him on the shoulder and walks back into the house. Vincent stays out admiring the view.

We pan up and a TIME LAPSE shifts night to morning.

PAN DOWN TO:

EXT. BOBA SHOP - MORNING

A boba shop downtown in LA. It's a warm, cozy morning in the fall.

Emi-Claire walks out of the shop with her friend MICHELLE (23, Asian American). They both have boba as they walk to the car talking.

MICHELLE

Wait, so how much studying did you get to do yesterday?

EMI-CLAIRE

Honestly? only like an hour.

MICHELLE

An hour?

EMI-CLAIRE

It's alright, I understand everything pretty well. I don't know why calculus is so easy for me.

MICHELLE

Seriously, you're weird. I went to tutoring three times.

They get back to the car and get in. It's Emi-Claire's, a somewhat nice, newer car.

INT. EMI-CLAIRE'S CAR - MORNING

Emi-Claire gets in the driver's seat and Michelle gets in the passenger. Emi-Claire reaches into her center console and puts her CD in the slot.

Depends on the rights but my picks are SIMPLE AND CLEAN by Hikaru Utada or ALL YOU WANTED by Michelle Branch.